



Tech Preparedness Quick Reference

Pierce County 4x4 Search & Rescue | piercecounity4x4sar.org

EMERGENCY

CALL 911

NAVIGATION APPS (scan QR to download)

AllTrails+ (\$36/yr)

Trail discovery + offline maps. Best for regular hikers.



[iOS](#)



[Android](#)

Gaia GPS (\$40/yr)

Serious backcountry topo maps. Used by SAR teams nationwide.



[iOS](#)



[Android](#)

onX Backcountry (\$30/yr)

Land ownership + hunting. Great offline topo maps.



[iOS](#)



[Android](#)

CalTopo (\$50/yr)

Trip planning + custom maps. Best for route analysis.



[iOS](#)



[Android](#)

Organic Maps (FREE)

Open-source offline maps. No account, no ads, no tracking.



[iOS](#)



[Android](#)

FREE OFFLINE MAPS (already on your phone)

- Google Maps:** Search area > menu > Download offline map. Expires in 30 days.
- Apple Maps (iOS 17+):** Profile > Offline Maps > Download New Map.
- Organic Maps:** Open app, zoom to area, auto-downloads. Free forever.

BATTERY + POWER

- Low Power Mode:** Enable at trailhead. iPhone: Settings > Battery. Android: Battery Saver.
- Screen brightness:** Reduce to 30-40%. #1 battery drain on any phone.
- Close apps:** Swipe away social media and unused background apps.
- Airplane mode:** ONLY if you have a separate satellite communicator. Otherwise leave cellular ON.
- Power bank:** Day: 5K mAh (1 charge). Overnight: 10K. Multi-day: 20K mAh.
- Cold weather:** Keep phone + bank in inside pockets near body. Cold cuts capacity 20-40%.

SATELLITE EMERGENCY + COVERAGE

- Satellite 911 texting:** FREE for all carriers via T-Mobile/Starlink (emergency 911 only). Full messaging: \$10/mo.
- iPhone 14+ SOS:** Built-in satellite SOS, no subscription. Practice in Settings > Emergency SOS.
- Garmin inReach:** Two-way satellite texts + SOS with 24/7 monitoring. ~\$15/mo. Best for backcountry.



Satellite 911 Signup (free)

<https://www.t-mobile.com/coverage/>



T-Mobile Coverage

<https://www.t-mobile.com/coverage/>



AT&T Coverage

<https://www.att.com/maps/wireless-coverage>



Verizon Coverage

<https://www.verizon.com/coverage-map>

Coverage maps are estimates. Actual signal varies with terrain, weather, and foliage. Most Cascade backcountry has NO cell service.